

Editor's Note

Josephine Lee

[W]e are not mathematical machines. We live, we breathe, we feel, we bleed. We are embodied human beings. Why should anyone learn mathematics if it doesn't connect deeply to some human desire, something we long for - to play, seek truth, pursue beauty, find meaning, fight for justice? You, as a mathematical explorer who is learning to embrace your identity in math, can be part of the movement to read people differently.

- Francis Su, *Mathematics for Human Flourishing* (2020)

How would you personally answer Professor Su's question? Why should you learn mathematics? In his compelling book published in early 2020, *Mathematics For Human Flourishing*, Professor Su gives us an in-depth look into 12 intriguing reasons to understand and to contribute to the glorious field of mathematics: exploration, meaning, play, beauty, permanence, truth, struggle, power, justice, freedom, community, and love.

I am still formulating my answer to his probing question, but the events of 2020 and 2021 have shaken us to the core of our beings and have made us reflect on fundamental problems in society into which math can provide insight. The devastation caused by the global pandemic, heightened tension in racial relations, and intense political strife has forced us to think more deeply about what pursuits are worthy of our time, treasure, and talents.

I was motivated to revive *Math Survey* in the fall of 2019 by my desire to creatively engage further with Stuyvesant's diverse and spirited math community. Little did I know that the crises in 2020 would make human exploration and connection absolutely paramount.

Despite all the recent monumental stresses on the Stuyvesant administration, faculty, staff, and students, the re-publication of *Math Survey* became a reality because of the dedication demonstrated by so many. Each of them deserves our sincere gratitude.

Principal Yu, thank you so much for stepping in this year and steering Stuyvesant through these unprecedented times. I'm looking forward to meeting you in person someday!

Principal Contreras, we appreciate how welcoming and encouraging you were during your years at Stuyvesant. Every time I walked through the door of Room 105, you showed me genuine interest and warmth.

Mr. Smith, I am grateful that you have been open-minded and responsive each time I've met with you and that you lead the math and computer science department so thoughtfully.

Mr. Rubinstein, thank you for believing in me and enthusiastically guiding me every step of the way as our faculty advisor, ever since my very first email to you. Your dedication to teaching and to math and computer science inspires us all. *Math Survey* is forever in your debt!

To the Stuyvesant Parents' Association, we greatly appreciate your support for the printing of *Math Survey* and enabling us to take great strides in publishing the inaugural Winter Edition.

Last, but certainly not least, to each member of our hard-working *Math Survey* staff, thank you for the tremendous effort you have put into meaningfully contributing to this enduring publication that started in 1927 with like-minded students. You are supporting the entire Stuyvesant math and computer science community in its commitment to human flourishing.